

Paul's Testimony of God's Glory and Grace

I started just going across the crowd, and I was able to stand up under it. I am learning a little bit more about it.

Hallelujah.

I think if you go to your history books, you will find that true intercession born out of compassion has always preceded great things that God has done.

Amen.

I heard again in the Spirit, "Who will cry for Me? Who will cry for Me?" But this time I was able to clear it up just a little bit.

People are starting to hear, and they are coming with pictures of their children. They have heard that God is bringing accountability for their children, children who have never walked, never talked. They are starting to come with pictures and give them to me, saying, "I am waiting. Please. We have waited for this."

But I understand that kind of fasting a little better, the kind where you lock up. You fast your body from everything but the presence of God, and you fast your soul from everything but subjection and knowledge to Him and His Word. You do not give your body any food. You do not give it anything. You subject it to the presence of God. It is the fast of the whole man.

You fast your spirit from everything but praying in the Holy Ghost.

I was about fifteen days in, and I had made mention in the camp meeting that Satan stood at the door for fifteen or sixteen days and I felt like I had to fight for my life. That would have been my interpretation, that it was Satan, because everything about it felt like him, except that I could hardly get rid of him. It seemed like if I could bring myself into any kind of joy, as soon as I let my guard down for a minute, even disciplining myself in joy, he would be right back.

About day fifteen, sixteen, or seventeen, I do not know how long, Elaine called and started telling me about the prophecy. She had canceled Australia to come here because something was going to begin to pour out in March. It would go here and into Cleveland, and then it would affect the whole state before it was over.

If God starts having revival in the major Bible colleges, that is exactly what will happen.

So there I was, walking Elaine's prophecy out and did not even know it. When she called and told me why she had canceled to come up here, I jumped up, and that other thing kind of left. Then three or four days later, I went into weeping for nine hours.

I could not get rid of it because it probably did not turn out to be the same thing. It was Him trying to slip me into that world where people do not have anybody to cry for them. I am probably talking about intercession. I have just been using the terminology because that is what I heard in my spirit: "Who will cry for Me? Who will cry for Me?"

In my overall view, I saw that twenty-year-old sitting up there, who had to have operations so her legs could grow, the tendons released, born with her spine open. A beautiful girl, twenty years old. She would never know what it would be to stand up or move on her own.

When you have all your hands and feet, when you are real cool and can move around and enjoy the blessings of God, your primary message is often even greater blessing than your hands and feet. It is not what you eat and what you wear. Even greater than that, your whole message is around how much God is going to do for me, do for me. As long as you are caught up in me, me, me, you are probably never going to cry for those people.

I am not being ornery about the blessings. They have never meant more to me. But I do not think it was Satan. I think He was trying to slip me into an intercession, and I did not quite know it. I was resisting it, binding it, saying, "Get out of here. Leave me alone." I should know better than that.

Where is the presence of elation and joy if He is trying to slip me into somebody's world, somebody who never walked and has to be carried around like a sack of potatoes, laid here and laid there? If He was trying to do that, the closest He finally got was the nine hours of weeping.

I think I can tell you this: you live in their world. Intercession means taking the place of someone to stand before God. We understand that for the lost. We intercede for the lost because the lost, in your mind, cannot stand for themselves. That is easy to understand. You place yourself on the road between hell and people trying to get there, and you intercede on their behalf. Somehow it gives God power to give you and them what you need to possibly see them into the kingdom.

It has been my experience that praying in tongues for edification causes you to get a good spiritual look at God's insight into the horrible things in your life that are keeping you. You enter into times of hating those faults and things about yourself, crying and weeping. That is a form of intercession that brings change.

Until you hate the things about yourself, the sin, promiscuousness, indifference, and complacency, until you begin hating those things, where does God get the faith to change you? Where would He get it from? If you do not care, where is faith going to come from?

This is why He slipped in this unique gift called tongues for personal edification. You do not care about anything. The Holy Spirit's ministry in you begins with edification, building you up above caring for nothing. Just by simple receiving by faith, He starts the process of building you up on your most holy faith.

Whatever realm we are in, it is hard for Him to slip you into somebody's hopeless world. It is hard enough for Him to slip you into the hopelessness of your own state and the world you live in, where Satan continues to make religion out of powerless churches, running after this and that, with very little to do with the lost and God and His mind.

It is hard enough for Him to get you beyond yourself, much less to get you to care enough to go totally after another human being and get them past it.

Please hear me. This is not a time in my life when I feel condemned. I am not trying to condemn you. I am telling you there is hope. I am telling you He is out there. I am telling you He has those miracles. I am telling you He has revival. I am telling you He has a life for you in Himself that precedes everything.

Once you start getting a look at it, there is nothing that can follow it. Nothing. There is not anything else.

Hallelujah. It is glorious.

I am still learning. I told you I did not understand what happened, or very much about it, but I also told you I would. I knew that once I settled down from the war, the Holy Ghost would be able to begin illuminating my mind with what was really happening and with the mysteries.

Obviously, I was fighting God and did not know it. He knew it. When it lifted, I got to experience that weeping. I have never seen people change so quickly. It makes me not want to get too far from all of it, because I have no idea what is going to happen next.

But I do know that God has something for us. Like never before, I want to seek Him.

Of course, I am having the pleasure of experiencing Satan's resistance. This is him now. He is just searching my ground for anything weak enough to get some hold on. I think he is a little afraid of what is coming down from heaven now. I think he is a little fidgety about it.

But I do not care, because if he could have killed me, I would already be dead. Is that not good news?

Hallelujah.

Something has been fastened in my spirit, and I have had the pleasure of looking at it for a few days. Actually, several months, but just enough to talk about it a little in these last few minutes.

Open to 2 Corinthians 10.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

The tenth chapter has one of our favorite passages, and preachers are faithful to quote it:

For though we walk in the flesh, we do not war after the flesh:

For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal, but mighty through God to the pulling down of strong holds;

Casting down imaginations, and every high thing that exalteth itself against the knowledge of God, and bringing into captivity every thought to the obedience of Christ.

What kind of weaponry would we need from God to pull down strongholds that can only be pulled down by His weaponry? What kind of stronghold could be so severe that it would take the weapons of God? It could not be carnal weapons. It had to be because of the walk of the Spirit.

He tells you what these strongholds are made of in verse 5: imaginations. An imagination is a system of thoughts empowered by emotion. These strongholds consist of systems of thoughts empowered by emotions that exalt themselves against the knowledge of God with the intention of displacing and replacing it with something that is not God.

That is what he calls strongholds. The reason these strongholds take the weaponry of God is that anytime deception, wrong believing, and systems of thought come in like that, they capture people easily because you are in a thought and belief system you are not resisting.

Paul was giving a warning here against false apostles and men who had been transformed into ministers of Satan. He said you should not be surprised about that, because Satan himself poses as an angel of light. So those he ministers to, Paul said, should not surprise you when they are also transformed as ministers of Christ or light.

What he was really talking about in chapter 11 is that the strongholds the Corinthian church was being put into came through false apostles who had taken men away from the simplicity that is in Christ.

In 2 Corinthians 11:4 he says:

For if he that cometh preacheth another Jesus, whom we have not preached, or if ye receive another spirit, which ye have not received, or another gospel, which ye have not accepted, ye might well bear with him.

He was warning them that in their present state, they would probably go with that man. He says:

For I suppose I was not a whit behind the very chiefest apostles.
But though I be rude in speech, yet not in knowledge.

He went on to say that he had been thoroughly made manifest among them in all things. He committed no offense. He did not rob them, take from them, use money against them, or anything like that.

Then in verse 13:

For such are false apostles, deceitful workers, transforming themselves into the apostles of Christ.

And no marvel; for Satan himself is transformed into an angel of light.

Therefore it is no great thing if his ministers also be transformed as the ministers of righteousness; whose end shall be according to their works.

He says they would probably bear with somebody preaching another Christ and another gospel because Satan is very convincing when transforming himself as an angel of light, and his ministers as ministers of righteousness.

You talk about being put into a stronghold that you think is God and is not.

For a long time I thought I had a pretty good handle on Paul's thorn. I do not think I had as good a handle as I thought I had, because I did not thoroughly understand the preceding chapters or the revelation in them.

But this one thing I do know: since August, when I got a look at Jesus' glory as in His glorified humanity, the position He holds with His Father as His Son, the firstborn of many brethren, I have seen that place He has given to you and me. That is what He was talking about when He said, "My glory I give unto you."

We have a lot of fun with Arnold Schwarzenegger, because if he gave you his glory, what is his glory? It is his body. You do not want to wear a shirt with sleeves when you put that much work into your body. If you were his disciple and he gave you his glory, you would end up looking just like him. You could not understand his glory, so you could not understand what he would want to give you, not just the body, but every aspect that goes with it: pride, people's oohs and ahhs.

Then there is the computer fellow's glory. His brain puts out so much power there is not enough left over to run his body. That is why he does not know what his body is doing: pencil pack leaking on his shirt, one sock with the pant leg stuck in it, bed head. But with one hand, he can break into computer defense systems. He is a hacker. If he gave you his glory, that would be amazing, because you would be hacking too.

But Jesus gave you His:

My glory I give unto you.

He gave me His. I was wondering why I saw Him in His glorified humanity. It was because that is what He gave me. He gave me His standing with the Father. What more could I want?

Along with that glory, I did not understand that part of the package of understanding the glory He said He gave to us was also understanding grace. With the glory goes the grace. There would be no "I give unto you" if grace had not accompanied it.

I thought I had a pretty good understanding of grace. But this has been focused in front of me. I do not understand the fullness of it yet, but I know He is trying to transform me against the future. He is trying to get me to a place where I will run like a crazy man, where you might as well beat me with a baseball bat, rather than be deceived by the devil into receiving one iota, the tiniest little inkling, of self-exaltation.

It is asinine to think you personally had anything to do with the grace He gave you in His standing. Hallelujah.

To stop along the way and begin to think there is something about you and your great person that made you special enough to receive His glory and grace, trust me when I say, run like a scalded dog. You are entering a danger zone. Do not ever enter into taking any of the glory, because that is what Satan will use to take everything apart.

"Who are you preaching to?"

Myself. You can just get in on it.

I told Him, "I am afraid. I am scared. For the first time in my life, I am afraid."

It is not the kind of fear of something that has the power to kill you, though it could do that. It is the godly kind. I told Him, "I am afraid." For the first time, getting a look at the whole picture, I am afraid.

I am afraid and fearful in this sense: because of what He has given to all of us freely and what He wants me to do. I know me. That is the problem. I am afraid that I would fall short. I am scared because He has let me see just enough that it has scared me. The responsibility has scared me.

It is the healthy kind of fear that calls for reverence and respect for what God has done.

Already people are calling and prophesying different things. I am hearing things that scare me. I am trying to sort them out, but I understand why grace is so connected to His glory. This standing He gave us is so unearnable, so inexhaustibly beyond attainment, that you could work at it for a billion years and never earn it.

The part He wanted me to see was that grace makes it absolutely asinine ever to begin to take any glory.

I am sorting it out now. I am understanding Paul's thorn a little better. This is the most difficult line. I am giving you as much as I am able to understand, because you who come to this service are mostly family. You are the ones mostly responsible for causing what is beginning to happen.

But there is something in that grace that Paul cried out for. When a person begins to understand how unearnable and unattainable this free standing is, then it is devastating to suddenly thrust your chest out and think there is something about your own personal greatness that causes Him to use you.

Hallelujah.

People appreciate being free. They come up and say, "Brother Roberson, your teaching has made me free." I enjoy so much that you give a portion of your life, and then people say it made a difference. Somehow seeing your family grow up, an inch at a time, through all the motel rooms and thousands of hours, just makes you lift your hands and worship. No other person in the universe had done that before, forsaking everything, but Jesus.

People come and say, "Brother Roberson, my life has been changed." I appreciate that. But after that last seeking time, when people would come up and want to say things like that, everything in me just wanted to run over the hill and hide. I just wanted to run away and hide. It was like there was some kind of holy ground a person could be in danger of treading on.

He was trying to get something over to me. I just wanted to run and hide. So I knew that after that nine hours of weeping, something was transforming in me to help protect me against the future and what I believe is coming.

It is self-exalted and foolish to think that because people have been taken out, you are somehow immune because you know the truth. I have the revelation gift, praying in tongues. Yes, I do. But you still have the humanity side of your emotions and all those things that have canceled anybody out.

If He is helping me die, that is why I wanted to run over the mountain, then let us get on with it.

God wants to use the daylights out of you. Just keep your eyes on Him.

For a long time He coined a phrase in me: "Give Him all the glory. Give Him the glory. All the glory goes to Him." For months and months, that is all I could do. I would get in and worship Him and give Him all the glory.

The less you take away from that standing He gave you, the more of that standing you are going to have.

Thank God for His grace.

Hallelujah.

If I am getting a glimpse of how God can come in a room, I wonder how much of it can come in before we are finished.

Hallelujah.

In 2 Corinthians 11, Paul warns against those who put people into strongholds, the kind of strongholds the weaponry of God can pull down. Paul is standing there teaching them that they are being put into a stronghold. "I am afraid you will go with this other Christ being preached. I should not be surprised, though. Satan himself transforms himself as an angel of light, and his ministers as ministers of righteousness."

Paul was probably one of the most dangerous men on the face of the earth that day because he had the weaponry, the mighty weaponry of God that could destroy those strongholds. Satan buffeted him because of the abundance of his revelations. That abundance made him dangerous.

We have a legacy. Most of us do not understand 1 Corinthians, much less 2 Corinthians. But this man left a legacy. God took it and set it as a precedent for eternity in the canon of Scripture.

How would you like to write a teaching that God used as a standard for righteousness for all time, for men to get victory? Do you understand the reward for holding one of the books of the permanent canon of the Scriptures of God?

Yes, he was dangerous.

Paul was warning against false apostles and establishing what you can glory in and what you cannot glory in. These men obviously gloried in their own self-exaltation and the rule they were beginning to take. So Paul gave himself as a small example.

"You say you are ministers of Christ. I am more."

Only the credentials he gave were: five times my back was striped, my bones and feet were broken, three times I was beaten with rods, I treaded water a day and a night, fastings often. He filed chapter 11 and said, "You all say you are apostles. You have exalted yourselves to the position. Do you want to look at my credentials?"

He said the same devil exalting them was trying to destroy him.

Paul said, "I would like to glory, but I will forbear. The only man I will glory in is that new man Christ has made me. Not the flesh, not the old one, but that man caught up fourteen years ago. If I am going to glory, I am going to glory in the grace of God that gave me the standing."

Look at 2 Corinthians 11. He gives much of his credentials there, but they are not like the credentials given today.

In verse 18 he says:

Seeing that many glory after the flesh, I will glory also.

He continues:

For ye suffer fools gladly, seeing ye yourselves are wise.

For ye suffer, if a man bring you into bondage, if a man devour you...

Then he says, in effect, "I speak concerning reproach as though we had been weak. But whereinsoever any is bold, I speak foolishly, I am bold also."

"You want me to glory in the flesh? Let me be a fool for a while."

Are they Hebrews? so am I. Are they Israelites? so am I. Are they the seed of Abraham? so am I.

Are they ministers of Christ? I speak as a fool, I am more; in labours more abundant, in stripes above measure, in prisons more frequent, in deaths oft.

Of the Jews five times received I forty stripes save one.

Thrice was I beaten with rods, once was I stoned, thrice I suffered shipwreck, a night and a day I have been in the deep.

"Deaths often" means he was put into more death situations where he was to be killed. In journeys often, in perils of waters, robbers, his own countrymen, the Jews. A group of them said they would not eat or drink until they killed him. Since he died of old age, I imagine a lot of men snuck off and did not tell anybody who they were.

He speaks of perils in the city, in the wilderness, in the sea, among false brethren, in weariness and painfulness, in hunger and thirst. That hunger and thirst was when he did not choose to fast; it was chosen for him. Then he says, "fastings often." For those who are against fasting, Paul listed it.

What was it, seven years ago, you did three days? My God, somebody haul some stones in here. We are going to build an altar right here.

He speaks of cold and nakedness. Part of the punishment was to take their clothes. Besides all those things outside, he had the daily care of the churches.

The devil kept taking the foundation and resisting it, turning them to Judaizers. My God.

Paul said, "Who is weak, and I am not weak? Who is offended, and I burn not?" If he needed to glory, he would glory in the things concerning his weaknesses, the infirmities.

Then in chapter 12:

It is not expedient for me doubtless to glory. I will come to visions and revelations of the Lord.

I knew a man in Christ above fourteen years ago, whether in the body, I cannot tell; or whether out of the body, I cannot tell: God knoweth; such an one caught up to the third heaven.

And I knew such a man, whether in the body, or out of the body, I cannot tell: God knoweth; How that he was caught up into paradise, and heard unspeakable words, which it is not lawful for a man to utter.

Of such an one will I glory: yet of myself I will not glory, but in mine infirmities.

Is it not interesting that he talks about that person as though it were someone else? But it was him. He is saying, "If I am going to glory, I am going to glory in the grace He has given me. I am going to glory in that new man, in the standing He gave me. I will glory in him, the one caught up into the third heaven. Of such a one will I glory; yet of myself I will not glory."

Not in his natural man, weaknesses, infirmities, or the old war. If he is going to glory, he will glory in that new man, in the standing Jesus has given him.

Paul said:

For though I would desire to glory, I shall not be a fool...

Then he goes into the classic thorn:

And lest I should be exalted above measure through the abundance of the revelations, there was given to me a thorn in the flesh, a messenger of Satan to buffet me...

For this thing he sought God three times, that it might depart from him. And God said:

My grace is sufficient for thee: for My strength is made perfect in weakness.

In effect, He said, "This standing I gave you, My grace, is sufficient. My strength is made perfect in weakness. Do you not get it? If you start glorifying Me for the position I gave you, if you start worshipping Me in the middle of those infirmities, when those people come and stone you, when perils come, when they beat your back, when you are treading water night and day, just begin to glorify and worship Me for the standing I gave to you. You will find out My grace is sufficient."

When you start glorifying Him and Him alone for the standing He gave you, then in the natural position you were brought through, when they are about to kill you, when you are in the middle of the ocean with no land anywhere, when you are being beaten, thrown in prison, with no food and no way out, He says, "Learn to glorify Me. Worship Me in the standing I gave you."

When you are weakest, stripped by the world, stripped by everybody and everything, stripped of dependency on the natural and the flesh, do not worry about it. You have His standing. Worship Him for that. When you are weakest, you will turn out strongest.

Paul said:

Therefore I take pleasure in infirmities, in reproaches, in necessities, in persecutions, in distresses for Christ's sake: for when I am weak, then am I strong.

In those situations, he learned to take great pleasure in activating God's grace and standing, because when he was weakest, he was strongest. It caused the power of Christ to rest on him.

You do not want to get weak glorifying God in the flesh. Who do you think you are? Who do we think we are? Do you think it was anything you did that gave you the standing? You had the privilege of selling out, but there was nothing you could earn. You could work a billion years and there would be nothing you could do.

You might as well begin to glorify Him for the standing He gave you in the middle of everything. Paul finally found out, after three times, that this is what causes Christ's strength to come to the forefront in the middle of every opposition.

You do not want to glorify the flesh or anything to do with it.

I started catching a glimpse of something in there I had not seen before. Satan came into buffeting because of the abundance of Paul's revelations, lest he should be exalted above measure.

I understand that strong man now. In his buffeting, he can drive you just as hard to take the glory. He can drive you to take it.

That is why Paul said, "Of such a one will I glory." I will glory in the standing Jesus gave me, and I will not take any of the glory away from Him.

"Come on, devil, give it your best shot. You are not going to get me to take any of the glory."

In fact, Paul found pleasure in serving Christ. When he was stripped of his dependency on the flesh, he was the strongest. In impossible situations, with absolutely no way out, when he was weakest, he was strongest, because when he glorified Him, His standing came forward.

Hallelujah.

Can you give Him all the glory?

Yes, sir.

Stand up and raise your hands.

Oh, Jesus, I wish I could transfer into you what I saw, the danger. This is the danger.

Oh, Jesus, we give You all the glory and the praise and the honor.

Hallelujah. Hallelujah, Jesus.

Glory be to God.

I worship You and thank You and magnify Your holy name.

Hallelujah.

Of course, there is that false religion of humility, the little penance devil. He will drive you to the nth degree the other way.

"You scum of the earth. You penance."

He will keep you missing His standing by trying to do penances with your own sins and your own self. You cannot do that. There is nothing you can do, no penances, no suffering, unless it is the suffering from resisting sin. There is nothing you can do to earn any part of His standing.

Hallelujah.

So there is a penance devil. But there is also that other devil who causes men to exalt themselves and literally think it is something about their special individual person.

Right. God wants to do something. He wants to step inside.

Do not slap Him. Let Him come. Let Him come. He wants to save Tulsa and everybody else He can get His hands on.